

IK 527: Sanskrit Language – Level I

Course Code	IK 527
Course Name	Sanskrit Language – Level I
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	PG
Mutual Exclusion	IK 101
Approval	64th BoA (May 2026)

Preamble

This course introduces students to the Sanskrit language, the foundation of India's intellectual and cultural heritage. Sanskrit, though ancient, remains relevant as the language of logic, science, philosophy, and literature in the Indian tradition.

The course aims to help learners acquire basic grammatical structures, pronunciation, reading, writing, and speaking skills in Sanskrit while also developing an appreciation for its linguistic precision and beauty.

Students will engage with simple conversational expressions, fundamental grammar, and short literary and cultural passages. The approach is communicative and activity-based, focusing on using Sanskrit as a living language.

After taking this course, students will be able to:

- Read and write in Devanāgarī script with correct pronunciation.
- Understand and use basic everyday Sanskrit expressions and greetings.
- Construct and comprehend simple Sanskrit sentences.
- Identify grammatical elements like nouns, verbs, pronouns, cases, and tenses.
- Recite and explain selected verses and moral stories in Sanskrit.
- Appreciate Sanskrit's contribution to India's intellectual and cultural life.

Course Modules

Classes will be supported by multimedia and conversation-based exercises.

- **Lesson 1:** Introduction to Sanskrit language, Indian Knowledge Systems, and Devanāgarī script. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 2:** Vowels (svarāḥ), consonants (vyañjanāni), pronunciation practice, and articulation points (sthāna-prayatna). (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 3:** Sanskrit greetings (namaste, katham asi?), self-introduction, and basic conversational expressions. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 4:** Introduction to nouns (nāma), gender (masculine, feminine, neuter), and vocabulary-building exercises. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 5:** Number system (singular, dual, plural) and introduction to pronouns (ahaṃ, tvam, saḥ, sā, tat). (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 6:** Introduction to verbs (asti, gacchati, paṭhati) and formation of simple Sanskrit sentences. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 7:** Introduction to vibhakti (case endings) and grammatical usage in simple sentences. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 8:** Common expressions and conversations related to greetings, family, and classroom interaction. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 9:** Conversational Sanskrit related to daily routine and practical communication. (1.5 hrs)

- **Lesson 10:** Present tense verb conjugations and sentence transformation exercises. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 11:** Introduction to past tense and future tense forms. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 12:** Verb conjugation practice (paṭhati, likhati, khādati) through role-play activities. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 13:** Introduction to simple Sanskrit stories and storytelling traditions. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 14:** Ekalavya and Hitopadeśa stories — reading and comprehension exercises. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 15:** Story narration, moral interpretation, and vocabulary extraction activities. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 16:** Numbers, counting systems, and time expressions in Sanskrit. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 17:** Colors, days, fruits, animals, household objects, and vocabulary-building activities. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 18:** Sentence formation exercises using vocabulary from daily life contexts. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 19:** Introduction to adjectives, participles, and noun-adjective agreement. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 20:** Basic prepositions and indeclinables (adhaḥ, upari, saha, vinā) with conversational applications. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 21:** Reading comprehension through short Sanskrit passages and moral stories. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 22:** Introduction to subhāṣitas (wise sayings), recitation, and interpretation. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 23:** Listening comprehension and pronunciation refinement exercises. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 24:** Spoken Sanskrit interaction, pair conversation, and group discussion activities. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 25:** Writing practice: composing simple Sanskrit sentences and short paragraphs. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 26:** Translation exercises (Sanskrit ↔ English) and guided composition activities. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 27:** Cultural exposure through Sanskrit recitation, chanting, music, dramatization, and role-play activities. (1.5 hrs)
- **Lesson 28:** Sanskrit for Innovation, AI, Computational Linguistics, Yoga, and Future Knowledge Systems — interactive concluding session connecting Sanskrit with contemporary science, technology, creativity, leadership, and holistic living. (1.5 hrs)

Total: 42 Hours

Laboratory Modules

- Reading and pronunciation workshops.
- Sanskrit conversation practice through pair and group activities.
- Chanting of simple shlokas and dialogues.
- Audio-visual support using Sanskrit e-learning resources.
- Role-play activities and Sanskrit games (*Sanskritam Khelāḥ*).

Text Books

1. Samskrita Bharati, *Samskṛta Bodha – A Beginner's Course in Sanskrit*, Samskrita Bharati, Bengaluru.
2. K. V. Abhyankar, *First Lessons in Sanskrit Grammar and Reading*, Motilal Banarsidass, Delhi.
3. Swami Prabhavananda, *Learn Sanskrit the Easy Way*, Ramakrishna Mission Institute of Culture, Kolkata.

References

1. A.M. Ruppel, *The Cambridge Introduction to Sanskrit*, Cambridge University Press, 2017.
2. A. A. Macdonell, *A Sanskrit Grammar for Students*, Oxford University Press, 2004.
3. Sanskrit Documents Repository: <https://sanskritdocuments.org>
4. Samskrita Bharati Online Resources: <https://sanskritabharati.in/>